

Face-2-Face with employer

“This career is exciting because of the growth opportunities it offers, the international exposure and the continuous focus on training”

Mr Vaidhya
Pronto Networks

What are the related paths in this career that you can pursue?

Depending upon whether one joins the IT operations of a company or a specialised outsourcing company, the career paths would vary:

In the case of IT operations of a company, one could join in any one of the areas:

- Data centre management
- Network management
- Other IT applications
- Technical help desk support

Within these technical roles, over time, the role quickly evolves to things like undertaking managerial responsibilities and evaluating various investment decisions.

In the case of specialised outsourcing companies, one could gain exposure across industries as well in addition to client development responsibilities, as one moves to senior roles.

Depending upon company policies, one can find the opportunity to move across different areas.

Why should you choose this career?

Viresh Gupta, Data Centre Head, JnK Bank says, "I was fresh out of engineering college and joined the bank after clearing an entrance exam. At that time, the bank did not have the concept of centralised data management. However, as the branch network spread, we realized that we couldn't manage the workload in a decentralised system. A decision was then taken to move towards a superior, centralised system. As I had been working with the bank for over 15 years, I was given the opportunity to be part of the team to manage the new centralised data centre. The new set-up has greatly improved the efficiency of the bank."

What are the required skill sets?

One doesn't necessarily have to be from an engineering background to get into this field. In addition, a number of certifications are being offered in the market (CDCP, CMM, CISCO certification, etc.) which are also added qualifications.

- **Continuous learner:** technology in this space is evolving rapidly. One needs to regularly keep oneself abreast of developments.
- **Problem-solving aptitude:** to be able to ensure that system runs smoothly 24x7, one continuously needs to anticipate problem areas and try to solve them proactively.
- **Leadership ability:** executives grow into leadership roles quickly. They need to keep their teams motivated and ensure their development in a fast changing technological environment

What makes people successful in this career?

☐ Aptitude for problem solving

A typical day would involve various problems to be resolved to ensure smooth functioning of centre/network. Emphasis is on ensuring process efficiency

☐ Ability to take initiative

From the beginning, team members are encouraged to give inputs for process improvements and see them getting implemented.